New Delhi Model: The World Inquiry

Evangelizing Our World Inquiry, a one-day consultation took place on the 6th of January 2003 at Bible Bhawan, New Delhi. It was organized by Evangelical Fellowship of India (EFI) and the chief resource person was Luis Bush. Richard Howell, General Secretary EFI, moderated the proceedings.

Listening to the Word of God and the insights on it was highly inspirational. The sharing by the participants of God's initiatives through church institutions and individuals added to the dimension of excitement and all became aware of how God is working in and around the city of Delhi. Expectation increased as the day went on that God was up to something new and great in our midst. Immediate commitments were made of resources, places and worship to take up the initial major concern for the leadership of Christ in this birthing initiative by means of intercessory prayer to seek his face on behalf of the people of the city of Delhi. The first specific agreement was to launch a city prayer watch inter- church initiative 24/7-twenty-four hours per day seven days a week in different churches who would take responsibility for specific focused prayer over a time period every week.

One approach to the transformation graphically proposed at the consultation was by means of increasing leadership influence of Church in the city (See Figure 1). The reality that was recognized that for the city to be transformed the church need to be transformed. It is a parallel process. Nominal Christians need to be renewed and transformation experienced by the spiritual core of the city.

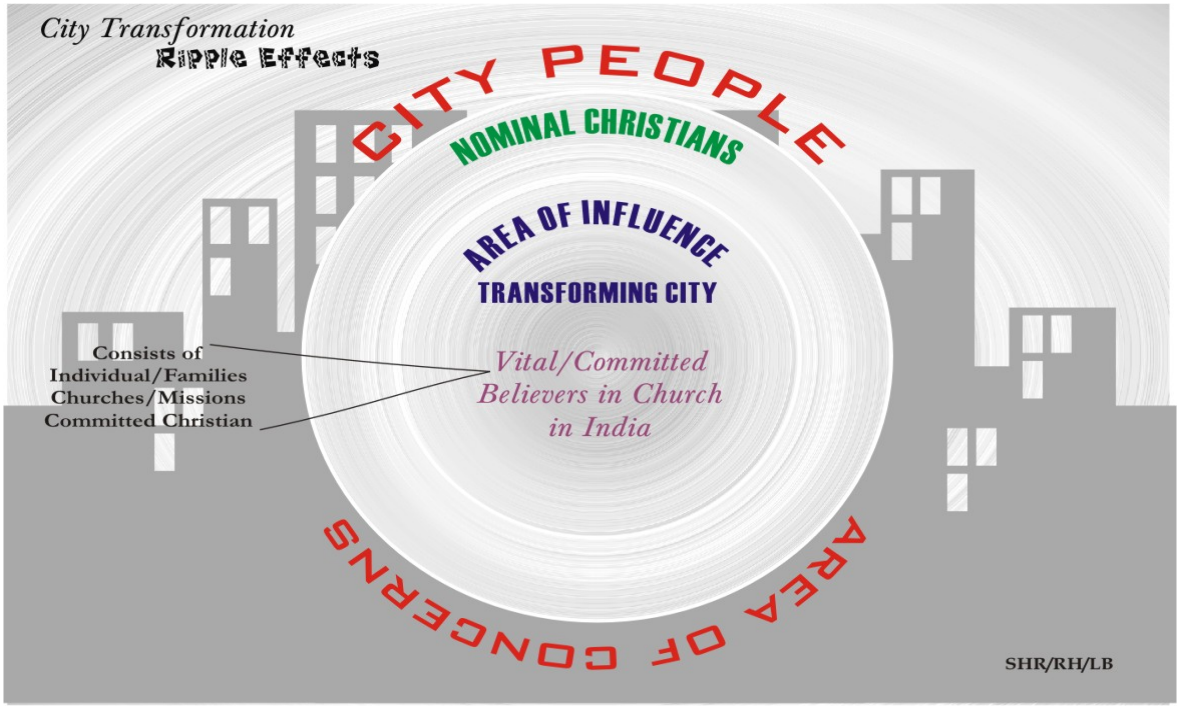


FIGURE 1: AREA OF INFLUENCE AND AREA OF CONCERN

City-Based Action Plan Emergence

During the India consultations in early 2003 a pattern emerged as city after city inquiry led immediately to action plans. Certain questions of the inquiry became the basis for very distinct action steps (See Figure 2).

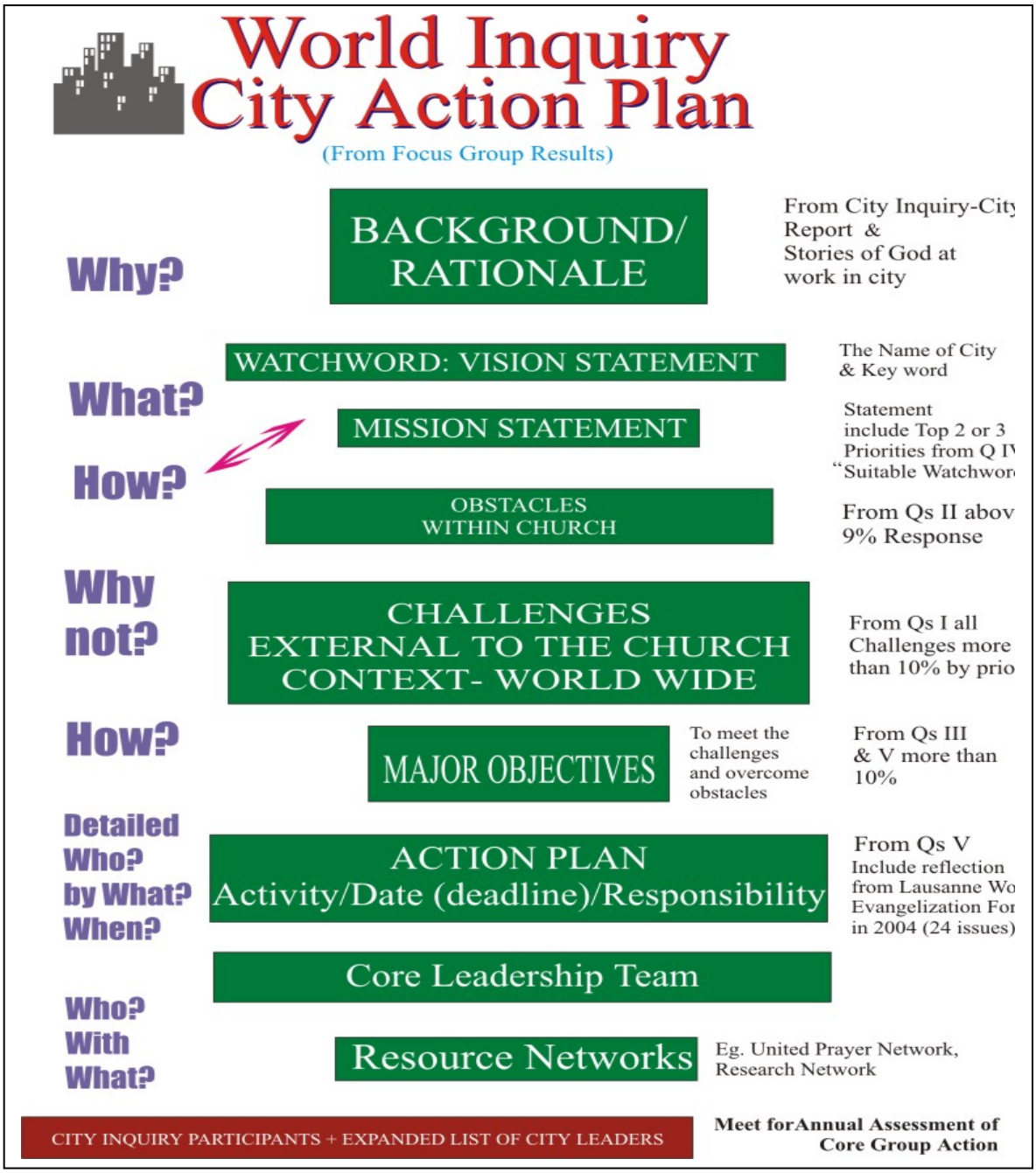


Figure 2

World Inquiry City-Based Action Plan

Integrated Response of Focus Groups of Five Leaders Each

The major challenges facing the Church in Delhi

1. Materialism
2. Religious fundamentalism
3. The relevance of Christian faith
4. Post modernity
5. Unreached social groups e.g. the youth.

The major obstacles internal to the Church in Delhi

1. Lack of vision
2. Lack of united prayer
3. Unhealthy churches that are not able to reproduce themselves
4. Lack of effective leadership
5. Lack of effective cooperation and coordination

God's call to His people for evangelization over the next 25 years

1. Seeking social transformation
2. Establishing an indigenous people's group
3. Preaching the gospel to every person using personal evangelism

Suitable phrase/watchword for the next 25 years

The Whole Church Taking the Whole Gospel to the Whole City

1. Discipling the Nation/City
2. Transforming our World/City
3. Filling the World/City with the Glory of God

Global Evangelical structures to enhance city/world evangelization efforts

1. Inspiration and prayer networks
2. Leadership development
3. Relationship building with other leaders/fellowship network opportunities
4. Resource networks linking to resource geographical and/or functional world evangelization initiatives
5. Reports of what is happening in other cities/countries

New Delhi Model: The Action Plan

Based on the above reflection an Action Plan emerged:

Watchword - Transformational Movement New Delhi

Mission Statement

The whole Church taking the whole Gospel to the whole city of Delhi so that the power, the presence and the peace of God is experienced by all and the country is discipled.

Major objectives

- Acknowledge the Lordship and leadership of Christ as the head of the body of Christ in Delhi.
- Develop a city leadership team submitted to the Lordship criteria and committed to the Delhi City Transformation mission.
- Facilitate a Delhi city- based Transformational mission initiative.
- Build a community of truth, love and faith especially in the urban heart of India through the multiplication of the World Inquiry Process through the city of Delhi and the nation of India.
- Increase the positive influence of the church in the spheres of life/community in Delhi such as medical, primary health care, communal harmony, educational, legal, slum, political, refugees by means of a common vision, effective communication and developing people's skills of individual Christians, churches and other Christian structures and the community of believers in the city of Delhi.
- Raise up Delhi City

Transformation advocates

- Raise up Delhi City Transformation implementers for the different city-based networks.
- Seek to bring positive change
- Proclaim in word and deed the good news of the Gospel to the poor, the oppressed, the sick and the marginalized of Delhi with intentionality and to every person in the city of Delhi.
- Support existing and build new ongoing, life- giving united programs and projects that minister to the poor, the oppressed, the sick and the marginalized of Delhi.
- Establish meaningful training mechanisms with appropriate training materials for the discipling of the people in each congregation in the city.

- Establish a congregation of believers in every class and kind of people and within practical and relational reach of every person, that are permeating every segment of society in Delhi with the love, truth and saving power of Jesus Christ.
- Cultivate younger leaders for leadership and in their discipling of younger people.

Immediate Action Plan

- City watch prayer 24/7 for Delhi by end of February 2003
- Reproduce/multiply the World Enquiry process among four geographical areas of Delhi by the end of February 2003
- Hold a National Consultation with the leaders of the Inquiries in each of the 20 major cities in which city-wide consultations were held in January 2003 by September 30, 2003.
- Reproduce/Multiply the World Enquiry process among 320 cities in India with more than 1,000,000 by the end of December 2004.
- Build a City Transformation network of 16,000 (50 X 320) Christian leaders by December 30, 2004.
- Establish/strengthen Delhi based resource networks for prayer, youth, family, marginalized, refugees, transients, AIDS, political leadership, women, evangelism, unreached people, saturation church planting, revived families, professionals, etc by December 31, 2004.
- Establish a monitoring centre for information gathering and distribution.
- Conduct workshops on transformational leadership with special emphasis on younger leaders (under 35 years old) in 320 cities (over 100,000) by December 2005.

It was decided that the programs and processes highlighted in the consultation and the steps suggested in the action plan should be regularly and continuously followed up by a core group from among the participants of the consultation. Accordingly, a core group was formed.

Conclusion

The Inquiries were highly motivational, and spirit filled. The unanimous Mission Statement focused on the need to mobilize the whole Church to take the whole Gospel to the whole city so that the cities are is transformed by the power, the presence, the peace of God for all and the country is discipled. The strategy is based on principles of communication and partnership. The transformation of communities to reflect Kingdom values is a Christological concern for it recognizes that enabling people to experience Christ's Lordship is the key to holistic ministry.

World Inquiry Questions for Focus Group

Question I. 2-18. (Omit Question 1) What are the major external challenges facing the Church regarding evangelization in our city or country?

Select 3 only & rank from the highest=1, 2=second highest, 3=third highest		1=highest
2	Globalization—the internationalizing of our shrinking world due to rapid communication toward a common culture	
3	Racial Tension	
4	Pluralism—the coexistence within the one political community of groups who hold incompatible views regarding religion	
5	Illiteracy	
6	Post-modernity—exhaustion of modernity. It celebrates diversity, fragmentation, ambivalence	
7	Religious fundamentalism	
8	Persecution/Political opposition/Injustice	
9	Technological advances	
10	Unreached linguistic and ethno-cultural peoples	
11	Unreached geographic areas	
12	Unreached social groupings - such as the youth	
13	AIDS and other major diseases	
14	Materialism/Distraction	
15	Relevance of the Christian Faith	
16	Food and Water	
17	Other. Please specify	

Question II. 22-36. (Omit Questions 18-21) What are the major obstacles internal to the Church to participate effectively in world evangelization (beyond the city)?

Select 3 only & rank from the highest=1, 2=second highest, 3=third highest		1=highest
22	Lack of money	
23	Lack of effective leadership	
24	Lack of vision	
25	Lack of workers	
26	Lack of training of workers	
27	Lack of appreciation by outsiders of contextualized local distinctives	
28	Opposition from inside the church	
29	Family issues	
30	Lack of united prayer	
31	Lack of good research and information on the remaining task	
32	Lack of effective cooperation and coordinated action between mission agencies	
33	No common goals or strategies for world evangelization	
34	Unhealthy churches that are not able to reproduce themselves	
35	Other. Please specify_____	

Question III. 37-47. (Omit Question 36) What do you believe God is calling His people to do in world evangelization over the next 25 years?
Select 3 only & rank from the highest=1, 2=second highest, 3=third highest

		1=highest
37	Preach the gospel to every person using personal evangelism	
38	Make the Scriptures and gospel message available in every language for both literate and non-reading by radio, TV, the Jesus Film, Bible translation and distribution and by CD	
39	Do you believe God is calling you to set goals for your ministry?	
40	Seek social transformation—seeking positive change in the whole of human life materially, socially and spiritually, by recovering our true identity as human beings created in the image of God and discovering our true vocation as productive stewards, faithfully caring for our world and people.	
41	For the church to be a prophetic voice to the city	
42	Establish an indigenous church planting movement within every people group on earth	
43	Reach unreached social groups such as the youth	
44	Ethnic Reconciliation	
45	Develop regional and global mission-field partnerships for mission agency cooperation and coordination	
46	Get the church involved in things like: • developing a primary health care network • improving the health of communities • teaching adults, and especially women, to read and write • establishing primary schools for those who have no schools • developing vocational training programs to give skills to young people	

Question IV. 48-59. (Omit Question 47) What would be a suitable phrase (watchword) to capture the essence of world evangelization to serve as a unifying paradigm for the next 25 years?

	Select 3 only & rank from the highest=1, 2=second highest, 3=third highest	1=highest
48	The Whole Church taking the Whole Gospel to the Whole World	
49	Fill the World with the Glory of God/ God's Glory for All	
50	The Power, the Presence and the Peace of God for all	
51	City-reaching	
52	Social Transformation/ Transforming our World	
53	Turning the World Right Side Up/ Changing Our World	
54	Christ's Kingdom Come	
55	The Church for Every People	
56	The Evangelization of the World in This Generation	
57	Discipling the nations	
58	Should the watchword have the time frame of 2025?	

Question V. 60-72. (Omit Question 59) How important are the following for Global Evangelical Structures provide to local believers to enhance world evangelization efforts?

	Select 3 only & rank from the highest=1, 2=second highest, 3=third highest	1=highest
60	Inspiration and prayer networks	
61	Serve their country/Bless their country/Nation building	
62	Leadership development	
63	Pertinent information for world evangelization	
64	Resource networks linking to resource geographical and/ or functional world evangelization initiatives	
65	Functional networks linking by ministry-type	
66	Reports of what is happening in other cities/countries	
67	Relationship building with other leaders/Fellowship networking opportunities	
68	Place and opportunity for missiological reflection	
69	Geographical networking opportunities	
70	Place for publications on missiological issues	
71	Other. Please specify_____	